Meal Planner: 3 Dinners a Week

Plan 3 real dinners. Pick the rest from 60 easy meals.

1	2	3
Plan 3 dinners	**Shop by section**	**Pick the rest**
Weekly Plan, p.11	Grocery List, p.12	60 meals, pp.5–9

No-Cook · 10-Minute · One-Pan · Backup · Snack-Plate

US LETTER

Undated · ADHD-friendly · 28 pages

Three Things Planners · Meals

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How to use

Four steps. That is the whole system.

1 **Write 5 meals you already eat.**

Put them on My Safe Meals (p.4). These are your easy wins.

2 **Choose 3 dinners for the week.**

Use the Weekly Plan (p.11). Tick a night and write the first step.

3 **Write the grocery list by section.**

Use p.12, so you walk each aisle once.

4 **Every other night, just pick one.**

Take any meal from the Library (pp.5–9) or your Safe Meals. No guilt.

Can't decide? Cut out the meal cards and pull one from a jar. Fell off the plan? Go to the Restart Page (p.27).

My Safe Meals

Meals I'll actually eat.

Meal	Effort (min)	Who likes it
1	☐ 5 ☐ 15 ☐ 30	
2	☐ 5 ☐ 15 ☐ 30	
3	☐ 5 ☐ 15 ☐ 30	
4	☐ 5 ☐ 15 ☐ 30	
5	☐ 5 ☐ 15 ☐ 30	
6	☐ 5 ☐ 15 ☐ 30	
7	☐ 5 ☐ 15 ☐ 30	
8	☐ 5 ☐ 15 ☐ 30	
9	☐ 5 ☐ 15 ☐ 30	
10	☐ 5 ☐ 15 ☐ 30	
11	☐ 5 ☐ 15 ☐ 30	
12	☐ 5 ☐ 15 ☐ 30	
13	☐ 5 ☐ 15 ☐ 30	
14	☐ 5 ☐ 15 ☐ 30	
15	☐ 5 ☐ 15 ☐ 30	
16	☐ 5 ☐ 15 ☐ 30	
17	☐ 5 ☐ 15 ☐ 30	
18	☐ 5 ☐ 15 ☐ 30	
19	☐ 5 ☐ 15 ☐ 30	
20	☐ 5 ☐ 15 ☐ 30	

Meal Library: No-Cook

Zero cooking. Open, assemble, eat.

12 meals · 6 ingredients or fewer

tick the ones you liked, then add them to My Safe Meals, p.4

1. **Hummus crunch wrap**
   wrap · hummus · cucumber · grated carrot · feta
   0 min cook ☐ liked

2. **Tuna & white bean salad**
   tinned tuna · tinned white beans · red onion · olive oil · lemon
   0 min cook ☐ liked

3. **Tomato mozzarella plate**
   mozzarella · tomatoes · basil · olive oil · crusty bread
   0 min cook ☐ liked

4. **Chicken Caesar wrap**
   ready-cooked chicken · wraps · lettuce · Caesar dressing · parmesan
   0 min cook ☐ liked

5. **Yogurt granola bowl**
   Greek yogurt · granola · berries · honey
   0 min cook ☐ liked

6. **Smoked salmon bagel**
   bagels · cream cheese · smoked salmon · cucumber
   0 min cook ☐ liked

7. **Smashed chickpea sandwich**
   tinned chickpeas · mayo · lemon · bread · lettuce
   0 min cook ☐ liked

8. **Turkey & cheese roll-ups**
   sliced turkey · cheese slices · lettuce · mustard · crackers
   0 min cook ☐ liked

9. **Peanut butter banana wrap**
   wrap · peanut butter · banana · honey
   0 min cook ☐ liked

10. **Black bean & corn salad**
    tinned black beans · sweetcorn · tomatoes · avocado · lime · tortilla chips
    0 min cook ☐ liked

11. **Cottage cheese crunch bowl**
    cottage cheese · cherry tomatoes · cucumber · crackers · black pepper
    0 min cook ☐ liked

12. **Overnight oats jar**
    rolled oats · milk · yogurt · frozen berries · honey
    0 min cook ☐ liked

Check labels for allergies.

Meal Library: 10-Minute

Already written. Pick one, cook it, done.

12 meals · 6 ingredients or fewer

tick the ones you liked, then add them to My Safe Meals, p.4

1. **Egg fried rice** — ~10 min — ☐ liked
   cooked rice · eggs · frozen peas · soy sauce · spring onion
2. **Bean & cheese quesadilla** — ~10 min — ☐ liked
   tortillas · grated cheese · tinned black beans · salsa
3. **Pesto pasta with peas** — ~10 min — ☐ liked
   pasta · jarred pesto · frozen peas · parmesan
4. **Cheesy scrambled eggs on toast** — ~10 min — ☐ liked
   eggs · bread · butter · cheese · cherry tomatoes
5. **Garlic butter noodles** — ~10 min — ☐ liked
   noodles · butter · garlic · soy sauce · spring onion
6. **Tuna melt** — ~10 min — ☐ liked
   bread · tinned tuna · mayo · cheese
7. **Shortcut chickpea curry** — ~10 min — ☐ liked
   tinned chickpeas · curry paste · coconut milk · spinach · microwave rice
8. **Halloumi wraps** — ~10 min — ☐ liked
   halloumi · wraps · salad leaves · hummus
9. **Prawn stir-fry noodles** — ~10 min — ☐ liked
   frozen prawns · stir-fry veg · noodles · soy sauce · garlic
10. **Beans on cheesy toast** — ~10 min — ☐ liked
    bread · baked beans · cheese · butter
11. **Gnocchi in tomato sauce** — ~10 min — ☐ liked
    gnocchi · tinned tomatoes · garlic · mozzarella
12. **Teriyaki tofu rice bowl** — ~10 min — ☐ liked
    firm tofu · teriyaki sauce · microwave rice · frozen edamame

> Check labels for allergies.

Meal Library: One-Pan & Sheet-Pan

Everything in one pan or tray. One thing to wash.

12 meals · 6 ingredients or fewer

tick the ones you liked, then add them to My Safe Meals, p.4

1. **Sheet-pan sausages & veg** — sausages · potatoes · peppers · red onion · olive oil — **~25 min, 1 pan** — ☐ liked
2. **One-pan chicken fajitas** — chicken strips · peppers · onion · fajita spice · tortillas · sour cream — **~25 min, 1 pan** — ☐ liked
3. **Tray-baked salmon & green beans** — salmon fillets · green beans · new potatoes · lemon · olive oil — **~25 min, 1 pan** — ☐ liked
4. **One-pot tomato pasta** — pasta · tinned tomatoes · garlic · stock cube · spinach · parmesan — **~25 min, 1 pan** — ☐ liked
5. **Crispy sheet-pan gnocchi** — gnocchi · cherry tomatoes · courgette · olive oil · mozzarella — **~25 min, 1 pan** — ☐ liked
6. **Sausage & bean casserole** — sausages · tinned beans · tinned tomatoes · onion · paprika — **~25 min, 1 pan** — ☐ liked
7. **One-pan chicken & rice** — chicken thighs · rice · stock cube · frozen peas · onion · paprika — **~25 min, 1 pan** — ☐ liked
8. **Sheet-pan nachos** — tortilla chips · tinned black beans · grated cheese · salsa · jalapeños — **~25 min, 1 pan** — ☐ liked
9. **Red lentil dal** — red lentils · tinned tomatoes · onion · curry powder · coconut milk · spinach — **~25 min, 1 pan** — ☐ liked
10. **Potato & chorizo skillet** — potatoes · chorizo · peppers · onion · eggs — **~25 min, 1 pan** — ☐ liked
11. **Honey garlic chicken traybake** — chicken thighs · carrots · red onion · honey · garlic · olive oil — **~25 min, 1 pan** — ☐ liked
12. **Halloumi & veg traybake** — halloumi · courgette · peppers · red onion · olive oil · pitta — **~25 min, 1 pan** — ☐ liked

> Check labels for allergies.

Meal Library: Freezer & Pantry Backup

For the nights the fridge is empty.

12 meals · 6 ingredients or fewer

tick the ones you liked, then add them to My Safe Meals, p.4

1. **Frozen dumplings & greens**
   frozen dumplings · frozen spinach · soy sauce · chilli oil
   from the freezer or cupboard ☐ liked

2. **Fish fingers, peas & mash**
   fish fingers · frozen peas · instant mash · butter
   from the freezer or cupboard ☐ liked

3. **Pantry tuna pasta**
   pasta · tinned tuna · tinned sweetcorn · mayo
   from the freezer or cupboard ☐ liked

4. **Freezer pizza & side salad**
   frozen pizza · bagged salad · dressing
   from the freezer or cupboard ☐ liked

5. **Rice & beans with salsa**
   microwave rice · tinned kidney beans · salsa · grated cheese
   from the freezer or cupboard ☐ liked

6. **Upgraded instant noodles**
   instant noodles · egg · frozen mixed veg · spring onion
   from the freezer or cupboard ☐ liked

7. **Jacket potato & beans**
   potato · baked beans · grated cheese · butter
   from the freezer or cupboard ☐ liked

8. **Frozen veg omelette**
   eggs · frozen mixed veg · cheese · butter
   from the freezer or cupboard ☐ liked

9. **Frozen meatball pasta**
   frozen meatballs · pasta · jarred tomato sauce · parmesan
   from the freezer or cupboard ☐ liked

10. **Tinned soup & cheese toast**
    tinned soup · bread · butter · cheese
    from the freezer or cupboard ☐ liked

11. **Cupboard bean chilli**
    tinned mixed beans · tinned tomatoes · chilli powder · frozen onions · microwave rice
    from the freezer or cupboard ☐ liked

12. **Cupboard peanut noodles**
    noodles · peanut butter · soy sauce · frozen edamame · lime
    from the freezer or cupboard ☐ liked

> Check labels for allergies.

Meal Library: Snack-Plate Dinners

A plate of bits is a real dinner.

12 meals · 6 ingredients or fewer *tick the ones you liked, then add them to My Safe Meals, p.4*

1. **Cheese & cracker plate** — assemble, no cook — ☐ liked
   crackers · cheddar · apple · grapes · walnuts
2. **Mezze plate** — assemble, no cook — ☐ liked
   hummus · pitta · olives · cucumber · cherry tomatoes · feta
3. **Ham & pickle plate** — assemble, no cook — ☐ liked
   sliced ham · pickles · crusty bread · butter · cherry tomatoes
4. **Veggie & dip board** — assemble, no cook — ☐ liked
   carrot sticks · cucumber · sugar snap peas · hummus · breadsticks
5. **Smoked fish plate** — assemble, no cook — ☐ liked
   smoked mackerel · rye crackers · cream cheese · cucumber · lemon
6. **Chips & guac plate** — assemble, no cook — ☐ liked
   tortilla chips · guacamole · salsa · cheese cubes · cherry tomatoes
7. **Bread & brie plate** — assemble, no cook — ☐ liked
   crusty bread · brie · grapes · chutney · salad leaves
8. **Antipasto plate** — assemble, no cook — ☐ liked
   salami · mozzarella balls · olives · jarred roasted peppers · breadsticks
9. **Fruit & nut butter plate** — assemble, no cook — ☐ liked
   apple slices · banana · peanut butter · rice cakes · yogurt
10. **Ready-cooked chicken plate** — assemble, no cook — ☐ liked
    ready-cooked chicken · bread rolls · coleslaw · cherry tomatoes
11. **Tuna cracker plate** — assemble, no cook — ☐ liked
    tinned tuna · crackers · cucumber · sweetcorn · mayo
12. **Lunchbox dinner** — assemble, no cook — ☐ liked
    cheese cubes · crackers · ham · cucumber · grapes

> Check labels for allergies.

Meal Builder

Short on ideas? Build dinner from four parts.

Pick 1 from each. That's dinner.

PROTEIN	CARB	VEG/FRUIT	FLAVOR
☐ Eggs	☐ Rice	☐ Frozen peas	☐ Soy sauce
☐ Tinned tuna	☐ Pasta	☐ Spinach	☐ Pesto
☐ Ready-cooked chicken	☐ Bread or toast	☐ Cherry tomatoes	☐ Salsa
☐ Tinned chickpeas	☐ Wraps	☐ Peppers	☐ Curry paste
☐ Tofu	☐ Noodles	☐ Cucumber	☐ Garlic butter
☐ Sausages	☐ Potatoes	☐ Frozen mixed veg	☐ Lemon
☐ Cheese	☐ Gnocchi	☐ Sweetcorn	☐ Chilli oil
☐ Frozen prawns	☐ Couscous	☐ Apple slices	☐ Hummus
☐	☐	☐	☐
☐	☐	☐	☐

Example: eggs + rice + frozen peas + soy sauce = egg fried rice.

Weekly Plan: 3 Dinners

Three real dinners. The other nights are allowed to be easy.

WEEK _____

This week's 3 dinners

plan the meal, tick the night, write the first step

1

MEAL _____

NIGHT ☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S

FIRST STEP _____

e.g. move the chicken to the fridge to thaw

SHOP FOR

☐ _____

☐ _____

☐ _____

☐ done

2

MEAL _____

NIGHT ☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S

FIRST STEP _____

SHOP FOR

☐ _____

☐ _____

☐ _____

☐ done

3

MEAL _____

NIGHT ☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S

FIRST STEP _____

SHOP FOR

☐ _____

☐ _____

☐ _____

☐ done

OTHER NIGHTS *Pick from Safe Meals or the Library. No guilt.*

☐ _____ ☐ _____

☐ _____ ☐ _____

If I only cook one: _____

BREAKFAST DEFAULT _____ **LUNCH DEFAULT** _____

Grocery List by Store Section

Write it by aisle. Walk each section once.

WEEK _____

PRODUCE *fruit & veg*

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

PANTRY *tins, dry goods*

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

MEAT & FISH *fresh counter*

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

FROZEN *freezer aisle*

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

DAIRY & EGGS *chilled*

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

HOUSEHOLD *non-food*

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

BAKERY *bread*

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

OTHER *anything else*

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

Staples Restock Checklist

40 basics, already listed. Tick what you have, then what to buy.

CUPBOARD	Have	Buy
Rice	☐	☐
Pasta	☐	☐
Noodles	☐	☐
Tinned tomatoes	☐	☐
Tinned beans	☐	☐
Tinned tuna	☐	☐
Tinned chickpeas	☐	☐
Rolled oats	☐	☐
Crackers	☐	☐
Peanut butter	☐	☐

FRIDGE	Have	Buy
Eggs	☐	☐
Milk	☐	☐
Butter	☐	☐
Cheese	☐	☐
Yogurt	☐	☐
Hummus	☐	☐
Sliced ham	☐	☐
Lemons	☐	☐
Carrots	☐	☐
Apples	☐	☐

FREEZER	Have	Buy
Frozen peas	☐	☐
Frozen mixed veg	☐	☐
Frozen spinach	☐	☐
Frozen berries	☐	☐
Fish fingers	☐	☐
Frozen dumplings	☐	☐
Frozen prawns	☐	☐
Sliced bread	☐	☐
Frozen pizza	☐	☐
Oven chips	☐	☐

FLAVOR	Have	Buy
Soy sauce	☐	☐
Salt	☐	☐
Black pepper	☐	☐
Olive oil	☐	☐
Stock cubes	☐	☐
Garlic	☐	☐
Curry paste	☐	☐
Jarred pesto	☐	☐
Mayo	☐	☐
Chilli flakes	☐	☐

Fridge, Freezer & Pantry Inventory

What is already in the house? Check before you shop.

FRIDGE

Item	Qty

FREEZER

Item	Qty

PANTRY

Item	Qty

Eat-First List

Use it before it goes off.

Item	Use by	Meal idea	Used?
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐

Tip: plan one of this week's 3 dinners around the item at the top.

Low-Energy Day Food

No cooking at all. Pick one and eat.

ZERO COOKING · ALREADY WRITTEN

- [ ] Bread with peanut butter and a banana
- [ ] Yogurt with granola
- [ ] Cheese and crackers
- [ ] Cereal with milk
- [ ] Hummus with pitta or carrot sticks
- [ ] An apple and a handful of nuts

MY OWN

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

☆ Eating something counts.

Breakfast & Lunch Defaults

Decide breakfast and lunch once. Then stop thinking about them.

MY 3 BREAKFASTS
1
2
3

MY 3 LUNCHES
1
2
3

IDEAS TO COPY *breakfast or lunch, both work*

- [ ] Overnight oats with berries
- [ ] Toast with peanut butter and banana
- [ ] Yogurt, granola and fruit
- [ ] Cereal with milk
- [ ] Cheese sandwich and an apple
- [ ] Leftovers from last night's dinner
- [ ] Hummus wrap with cucumber and carrot
- [ ] Crackers, cheese and grapes

One-Hour Batch Prep

One hour, three parts. Set a timer for each part.

0–20 MIN *Start the slow stuff: rice on, oven tray in, eggs boiling.*

What	Done?
	☐
	☐
	☐

20–40 MIN *Chop and portion while things cook.*

What	Done?
	☐
	☐
	☐

40–60 MIN *Cool, box, label, then a quick clean-up.*

What	Done?
	☐
	☐
	☐

Make 3 parts, not 3 full meals.

e.g. a pot of rice, a tray of roast veg, a box of cooked chicken. Mix them on the night.

Takeout Plan

Takeout is allowed. Plan it, so it is a choice.

TAKEOUT NIGHTS THIS WEEK ◯ 0 ◯ 1 ◯ 2 ◯ 3

WEEKLY TAKEOUT BUDGET _____

MY GO-TO ORDERS

Place	Order	Price

Cheaper swap from the Library: _____

Food Budget Tracker

Five weeks. Write the plan, then what you really spent.

Week	Planned	Spent	Note
Week 1			
Week 2			
Week 3			
Week 4			
Week 5			
Total			

> Over budget one week? Note why, then plan one Freezer & Pantry Backup night (p.8) next week.

4-Week Dinner Rotation

Repeat what worked. Boring is fine.

Week	Dinner 1	Dinner 2	Dinner 3
Week 1	again? ◯	again? ◯	again? ◯
Week 2	again? ◯	again? ◯	again? ◯
Week 3	again? ◯	again? ◯	again? ◯
Week 4	again? ◯	again? ◯	again? ◯

After 4 weeks, start again at Week 1. Same 12 dinners is a perfectly good plan.

Kitchen Dopamine Menu

Order something to make cooking less boring. Fill the blanks with your own.

STARTERS	MAINS	SIDES	DESSERTS
to get going	*while you cook*	*little extras*	*after dinner*
Put on one favorite song	A podcast episode	Taste-test as you go	Eat with a show you like
Pour a cold drink first	Call a friend on speaker	Use your favorite bowl	Something sweet, just because
Turn on the nice lamp	Cook along with a video	Dance while the pasta boils	Leave the pan to soak, guilt-free

Kitchen Reset: 3 Tasks

Three small jobs, then the kitchen is done for tonight.

TIMER ◯ 5 ◯ 10 ◯ 15 min

1

done

2

done

3

done

> Ideas: dishes into the sink to soak · wipe the counter by the hob · trash out if full. Timer rang? Stop there.

Optional, separate product (not needed for this planner): room-by-room 3-task resets in the ADHD-Friendly Cleaning Planner, https://phien0618.github.io/products/adhd-cleaning-room-reset/

My Recipe

One favorite, written down so you never have to look it up.

NAME

TIME **SERVES**

INGREDIENTS

- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]
- [ ]

STEPS *max 6 steps*

1

2

3

4

5

6

Who Eats What

Up to 4 people. What each person will eat, and what to avoid.

NAME _____

Safe foods	Won't eat	Allergies or notes

NAME _____

Safe foods	Won't eat	Allergies or notes

NAME _____

Safe foods	Won't eat	Allergies or notes

NAME _____

Safe foods	Won't eat	Allergies or notes

Weekly Food Review

Five questions, two minutes. No grades.

WEEK _____

1 What got eaten

2 What got wasted

3 Best easy meal

4 Move to Safe Meals?

◯ yes ◯ no

5 One thing to change

Restart Page

Fell off meal planning? Start here.

Fell off meal planning? Start here.

Nothing to catch up on. The planner doesn't keep score, and you can start again on any day. Three small steps are enough.

1 Write 1 Safe Meal

2 Plan just 1 dinner

MEAL _____ **NIGHT** _____

3 Buy 3 things

☐ _____ ☐ _____ ☐ _____

> One planned dinner is a full restart. Next week you can go back to three.

Restarts so far: ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○ ○

Notes

Lists, ideas, what worked.

Optional, separate product (not needed for this planner): daily and weekly pages in the ADHD-Friendly Printable Planner Pack, https://phien0618.github.io/products/adhd-printable-planner-pack/